

The Semester of Living Dangerously

Subsidized Direct or FFEL Stafford Loan	Loan: must be repaid	Subsidized: U.S. Department of Education pays interest while borrower is in school and during grace and deferment periods; you must be at least a half-time* student and have financial need.	\$3,500 to \$8,500, depending on grade level
Unsubsidized Direct or FFEL Stafford Loan	Loan: must be repaid	Unsubsidized: Borrower is responsible for interest during the life of the loan; you must be at least a half-time* student; financial need is not a requirement.	\$3,500 to \$20,500 (less any subsidized amounts received for the same period), depending on grade level and dependency status
Direct or FFEL PLUS Loan	Loan: must be repaid	Available to parents of dependent undergraduate students who are enrolled at least half-time.* The PLUS Loan Program is now also available to graduate and professional degree students. Financial need is not a requirement. PLUS Loans are unsubsidized: Borrower is responsible for interest during the life of the loan.	Maximum amount is cost of attendance* minus any other financial aid the student receives; no minimum award amount

There's a single form that all colleges use called the Free Application for Federal Student Assistance (FAFSA). Most financial aid information is easily available online from the school you are planning on attending. Generally there will be a connection or a link to web resources for scholarships and other types of aid. After you've submitted your FAFSA, you will start getting requests for information. You need to respond quickly and provide all the information that's requested. That way, you'll stay on time and get the best aid available.

Grants or scholarships generally don't have to be repaid, but loans do. The repayment doesn't start until six months after graduation. If you continue onto graduate school, these payments can be deferred (delayed) until your schooling is complete. The interest on student loans is usually much lower

